MONTHLY UPDATE

Botswana: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · DATA

Summary of the month

The President said the SmartBots digital transformation strategy will be formally launched in November 2026. The state wholesale operator announced a long-term lease of international capacity through South Africa on 23 September. The bankers' association launched a national electronic know-your-customer project, and a five-day workshop on the National Data Strategy ran from 7 to 11 September.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The data policy is being turned into something implementable. A five-day data governance capacity-building and stakeholder engagement was held from 7 to 11 September to translate the national data policy's principles and direction into a national data strategy, with continental and European support. No draft strategy or adoption date is published.

The national digital transformation strategy has a launch date. President Duma Boko told the UN Economic Commission for Africa in New York that SmartBots would be formally launched in November, with the commission sought as a continuing partner; no budget or targets are published.

Data protection

The commencement instrument behind the data-protection regime is now held in full: Statutory Instrument 86 of 2021 brought the Data Protection Act No. 32 of 2018 into operation on publication on 15 October 2021. It dates a regime the repository had been carrying from its 2024 re-enactment, and it is the kind of document that settles when an obligation actually started rather than when it was last restated.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 23 September the state wholesaler said it had signed a long-term lease with an unnamed South African partner, raising available international capacity through the Ramatlabama and Pioneer Gate crossings from 300 Gbit/s to 1 Tbit/s. The term and price were not disclosed. The state fibre operator announced the launch of its internet exchange point for local traffic; no member count is given.

The communications minister said the Universal Access and Service Fund's broadband expansion project has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the Trans-Kalahari Highway, a P34.5 million investment, with further coverage through infrastructure sharing due by the end of the next financial year.

Data Storage

The gas supplier's annual report said the Kala Data Centre ran materially below its design capacity in the year to June 2026 for lack of gas from the one connected well. Any expansion depends on gas availability, funding and commercial terms.

Energy

The facility's power is the unusual part. On-site gas-fired generation is supplemented by solar introduced to cover periods of lower gas availability, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review — solar specified as firming for gas, the reverse of the usual diesel-backup arrangement. An initial 5 MW solar development was assessed during the quarter and an extension of the gas gathering network to connect a further production well is stated subject to funding; neither carries a capital cost, approval or date, and the company states both are work-programme items rather than guidance. The second gates the data centre: capacity growth turns on upstream gas work rather than on demand.

The price of the energy the sector runs on is under review, and the utility's own case is a large one: its consultation paper makes the case for a 46% tariff rise on a P9.585bn revenue requirement against a P3.477bn funding gap. It is an application rather than a determination: no regulator decision, effective date or data-centre tariff schedule accompanies it, and the repository still holds no measured electricity cost for any digital facility in the country. The gas supplier has begun planning a dedicated pipeline from a second well to the centre's generators, subject to funding and approvals.

DPI

Data Exchange

The identity register is being opened to banks: the bankers' association launched a national eKYC project letting banks verify customers against the national citizen database, with no go-live date or data-protection arrangement stated.

Digital Payments and Fintech

A fourth came with a bank's annual results: FNBB said its eWallet will send funds directly into all three mobile-money platforms, with no start date or fee published.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A newspaper reported the transport ministry extending permits and clearing vehicles by hand after a systems outage at the road transport department.

Technology

AI

A US company announced on 15 September that its AI clinical decision-support platform will be extended to Botswana through the Botswana-UPenn Partnership, with a customised tool to be built with local clinicians. No timetable, site count or cost is stated.

Data

National statistics

One absence in that system was dated this month. No gambling participation statistics are held as the country moves to lower the legal betting age, while an investigation reports unregistered betting influencers drawing 4,000 to 15,000 responses to a single betting slip and directing followers to bookmakers through referral links. The activity is documented and the population is not counted, which is the gap a statistical strategy would have to close.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BWA/BWA-monthly-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0